

Create a sensory tunnel

Now that your baby is a young explorer, she is eager to explore the world around her. If she likes to play in toy tunnels, create your own sensory play tunnel. Turn a couple of large cardboard boxes on their sides, remove the tape from the bottoms to open up both ends, and connect them to make a tunnel that your baby can crawl through easily. Make a small hole in the roof and stuff a long sock through the hole so it dangles down into the tunnel. Tie a big knot in the top of the sock so it stays in position. Repeat with other brightly colored socks (check that they dangle down at different heights), and fill a few of the socks with scrunched-up newspaper and a baby's rattle. Encourage your baby to crawl through the tunnel with the socks brushing against her as she crawls. If she likes sitting inside it, cut a few peepholes in the sides so she can see you, add a few toys, and turn it into a fort, or let her lie inside and kick at the socks.

